fact, it would have been very difficult to achieve our advanced technological goals without the active partnership of our academic institutions.

Let us consider the example of the Agni payload breakthrough. Agni is a two-stage rocket system and employs re-entry technology developed in the country for the first time. It is boosted by a first-stage solid rocket motor derived from SLV-3 and further accelerated at the second stage with the liquid rocket engines of Prithvi. For the Agni, the payload gets delivered at hypersonic speeds, which cal s for the design and development of a re-entry vehicle structure. The payload with guidance electronics is housed in the re-entry vehicle structure, which is meant to protect the payload by keeping the inside temperature within the limit of 40oC, when the outside skin temperature is greater than 2500oC. An inertial guidance system with an on-board computer guides the payload to the required